As I mentioned earlier, the decision around my last match became needlessly controversial and blown out of proportion. When Subhan Ahmad – also our media manager – took my conversation with Inzi to the media, Najam Sethi read about it in the papers and began doubting our intentions. Soon, the coach – Waqar Younis – got involved. It all got very ugly. To solve the issue, Sethi said there was going to be no such farewell match and offered me an award and money instead.

I never wanted either. I just wanted to run a lap around the ground and thank people. That's it. But Sethi wanted me to accept the award money from him, in person. I refused. He eventually relented and okayed the farewell game. But it was embarrassing that he gave the award money to a charity of his choice, not my choice (Shahid Afridi Foundation). Unbelievable.

And here's something even more unbelievable. When Misbah-ul-Haq and I were doing our final goodbyes at the ground, Najam Sethi never bothered leaving his office for a minute to come over to the outfield to participate in the farewell. With the whole world watching Pakistan's Test captain, Misbah, and your humble all-rounder exit after twenty years, the cricket boss of the country never bothered to offer even a public handshake. Amazing.

Today, I hope there's no political baggage or bad blood between us. But during that controversy around the so-called farewell match, Sethi versus Afridi became an ego match instead.

To repeat: all I wanted to do was set a good precedent. That's all. I always was Shahid Afridi, am Shahid Afridi and will remain Shahid Afridi. A farewell match was never going to be the making or breaking of me. I wanted to create a new tradition. And I didn't beg for one just for myself.

I know I wasn't the perfect player, the greatest captain or the best man in the field.

The papers would say that my 'death or glory' approach was my downfall. They got it wrong, right from day one. They never understood that I was a spinner who could also bat on the side. They never understood that my temperament issue – which ran for years – was based on meeting those expectations set on that first day in Nairobi.

They didn't understand a lot.

And so, confused, lost and out of focus, I finished my international career in stages. Just 27 Tests, scoring 1,176 runs with a highest score of 156 and 48 wickets; 398 ODIs with 8,064 runs, a highest score of 124 while taking 395 wickets. And 99 T20I matches with 1,405 runs and 98 wickets.

But those are just numbers. And numbers don't matter. *Niyat* does.